

DDI at the Australian Data Archive



Steve McEachern
Deputy Director, ADA

with Deborah Mitchell (ADA), Ben Evans and
Olaf Delgado-Friedrichs (ANUSF)

EDDI Conference
December 2011



Presentation Overview

1. About ADA

- a) ADA in brief
- b) The ADA sub-archive system

2. ADA website and DDI

- a) Browsing
- b) Searching
- c) Viewing data and metadata

3. New tools

- a) Data visualisation: GIS, Longitudinal
- b) Data deposit: ADAPT

4. Current experiences with DDI

5. Future directions



1. About ADA

ADA in Brief



- The Social Science Data Archive (now ADA) was set up in 1981, housed in the Research School of Social Sciences, Australian National University, with a mission to collect and preserve Australian social science data on behalf of the social science research community
- Now includes nodes at University of Melbourne, University of Queensland, University of Western Australia, University of Technology Sydney, with infrastructure provided by the ANU Supercomputer Facility
- The Archive holds some 2400 data sets, including national election studies; public opinion polls; social attitudes surveys. Data holdings are sourced from academic, government and private sectors.

ADA NCRIS/NeAT development



The original research community needs identified by the ASSDA Advisory Panel to be addressed by the ASeSS project were as follows:

1. A coherent single point of access for nationally significant social science and associated humanities resources, including access for researchers, students, government bodies, and other external agencies.
2. Reliable access to the major national social surveys.
3. Management of a diverse range of data forms needed to help answer research questions across these different forms: eg: unit record data, qualitative data, economics data, including a high level of data documentation that allows researchers to quickly identify its relevance and quality for research purposes.
4. Easy access to specialised collections, eg: topic based data, such as data relating to ageing; colonial data; indigenous data.
5. Provide fast search across all this data.
6. Easy access to data analysis tools, including the development of advanced analytical and visualisation tools and capability (outside of commercially available products) that provide additional value to the data archives and support the 'unlocking' of otherwise inaccessible data sets of national significance.
7. Computational modelling, expertise and resources including computationally expensive statistical packages.

ADA Subarchives

- Social Science – predominantly survey or polling based quantitative social science data
- Historical – an archive of Australian census data tables from 1834 to the present day
- Indigenous – A thematic archive bringing together research data about Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islanders
- Longitudinal – major longitudinal cohort and panel surveys of the Australian population
- Qualitative – a new collection which provides specialist data archiving and access services to qualitative researchers
- Crime & Justice – major collections of data in crime, law and justice, including criminal justice administrative data
- International – a central point of access for links to international data sources around the world



The ADA Website and DDI

Approach

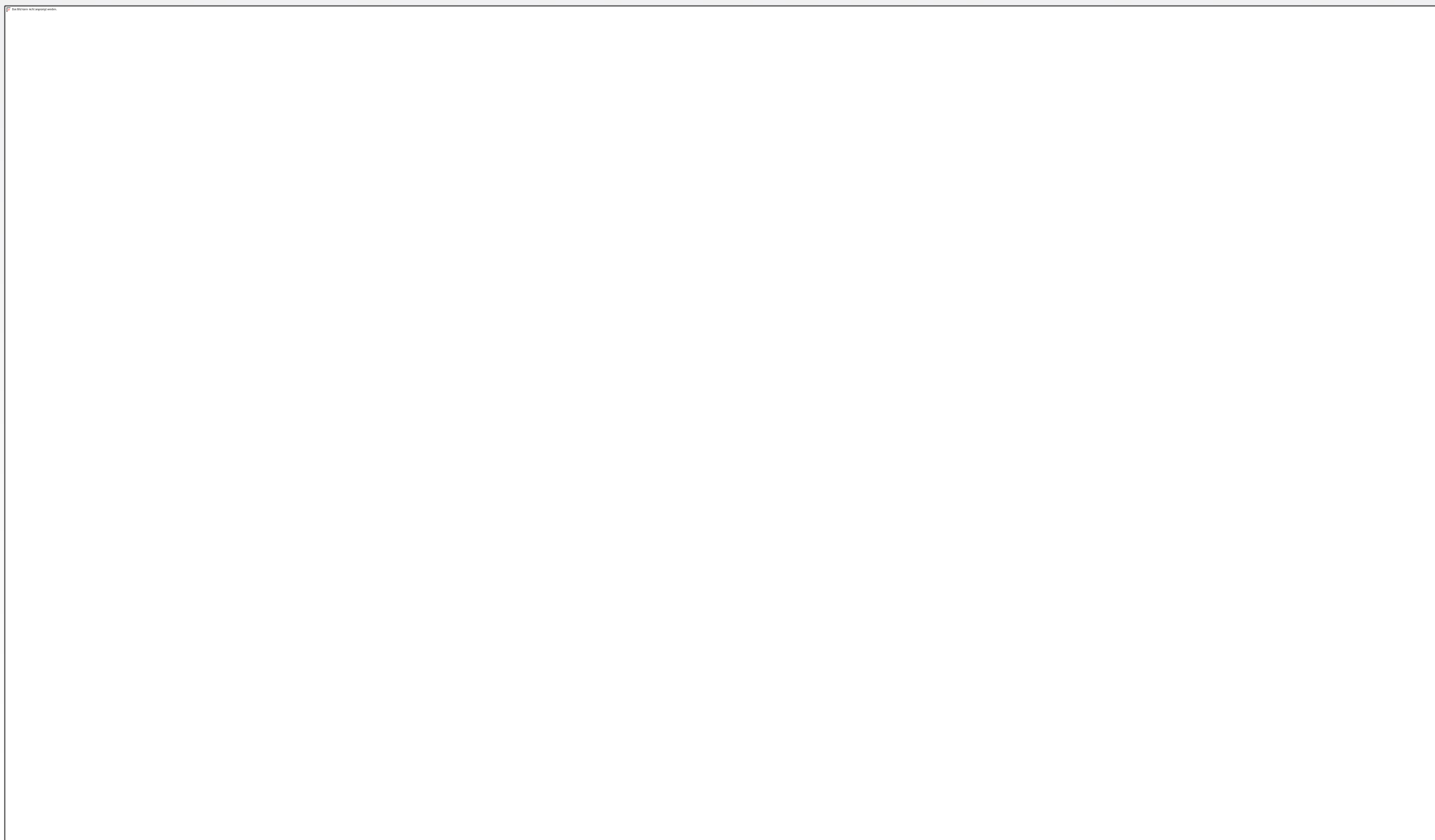
- Core archive website:
 - <http://www.ada.edu.au>
- Sub-archives focussed on specialised thematic or methodological areas
 - eg. <http://www.ada.edu.au/indigenous/home>
- “Add-on” systems for complex analysis or visualisation tasks:
 - Nesstar
 - GIS: <http://gis-test.ada.edu.au>
 - Longitudinal visualisation: Panemalia
 - Historical census data: <http://hccda.ada.edu.au>

New OAIS architecture





The ADA website





Data Access

Finding data

There are two methods for finding data in the Australian Data Archive:

- Browsing the ADA Data Catalogue
- Searching for data using the ADA search engine

Searching or browsing from within one of the ADA subarchives automatically limits the results to data from within that subarchive.

Search results



Browsing the catalogue

The ADA study page

Study information is available through the tabs at the top of the study:

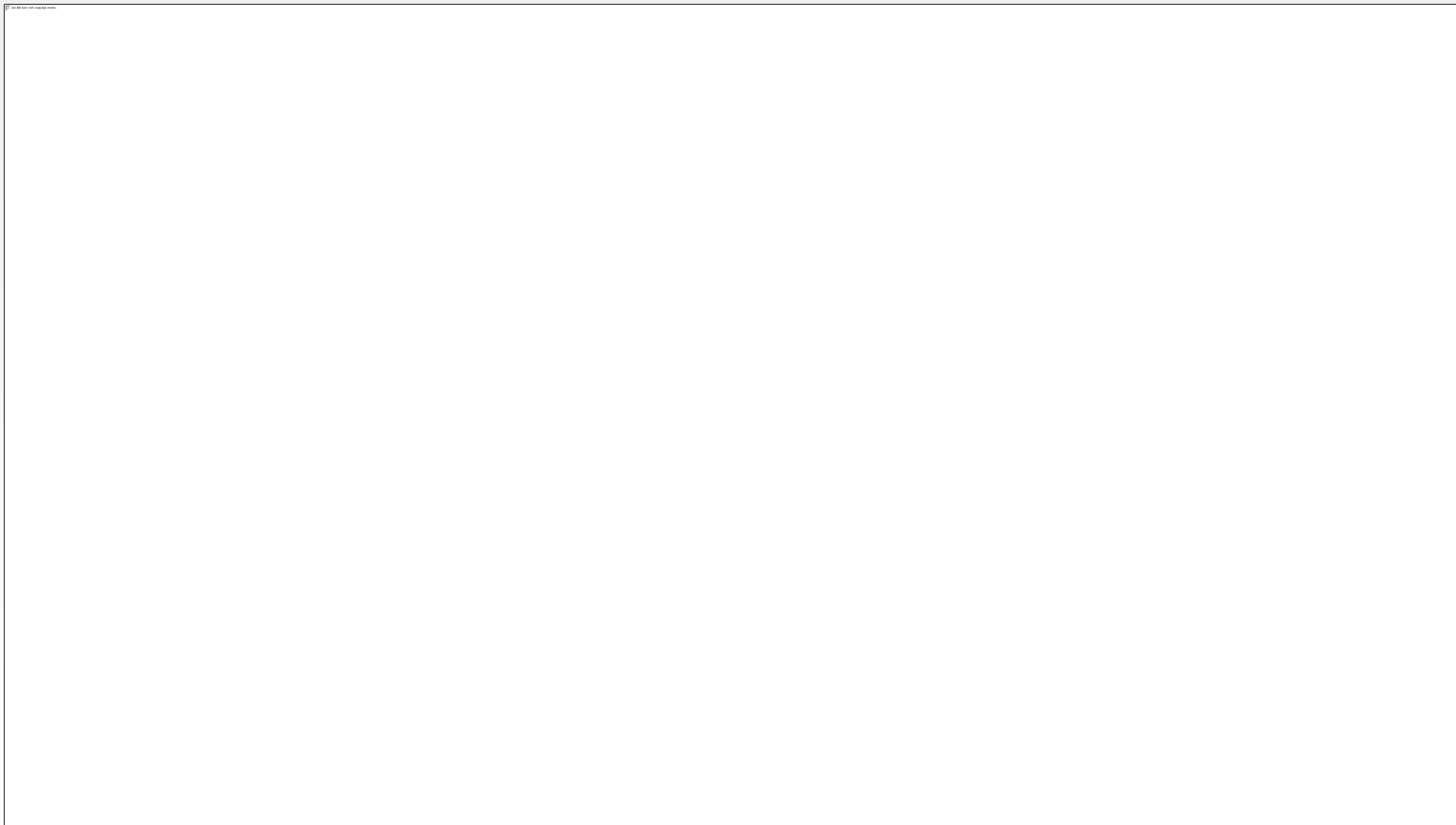
- Study: information including the investigators, abstract, sample, data collection methods, and access requirements.
- Variables: a list of variables available in a quantitative dataset
- Related Materials: additional documentation, links and other related studies (eg. others in the series) that may interest you

The study page is also the access point for the ADA Nesstar system, for:

- Analysis of quantitative data online,
- Download of data to your own computer.



The ADA Study Page





Other ADA functions

GIS visualisation

<http://gis.ada.edu.au>

[HOME](#) [SUBARCHIVES](#) [DATA ACCESS](#) [DATA DEPOSIT](#) [USER GUIDES](#) [ADA NEWS](#) [ABOUT](#) [MY ACCOUNT](#)

Search this site

YOU ARE HERE: GIS/DDI_01127

The Australian Survey of Social Attitudes, 2007

Variable Selection

Geography Selection

Type of Map

Map Options

What to map

percent

mode

histogram

Invalid/Missing/N.A. Responses

Include Invalid

Histogram Type

histogram

radar

spie

Colour Scheme

v66 Urgent environmental concern- Climate change: histogram

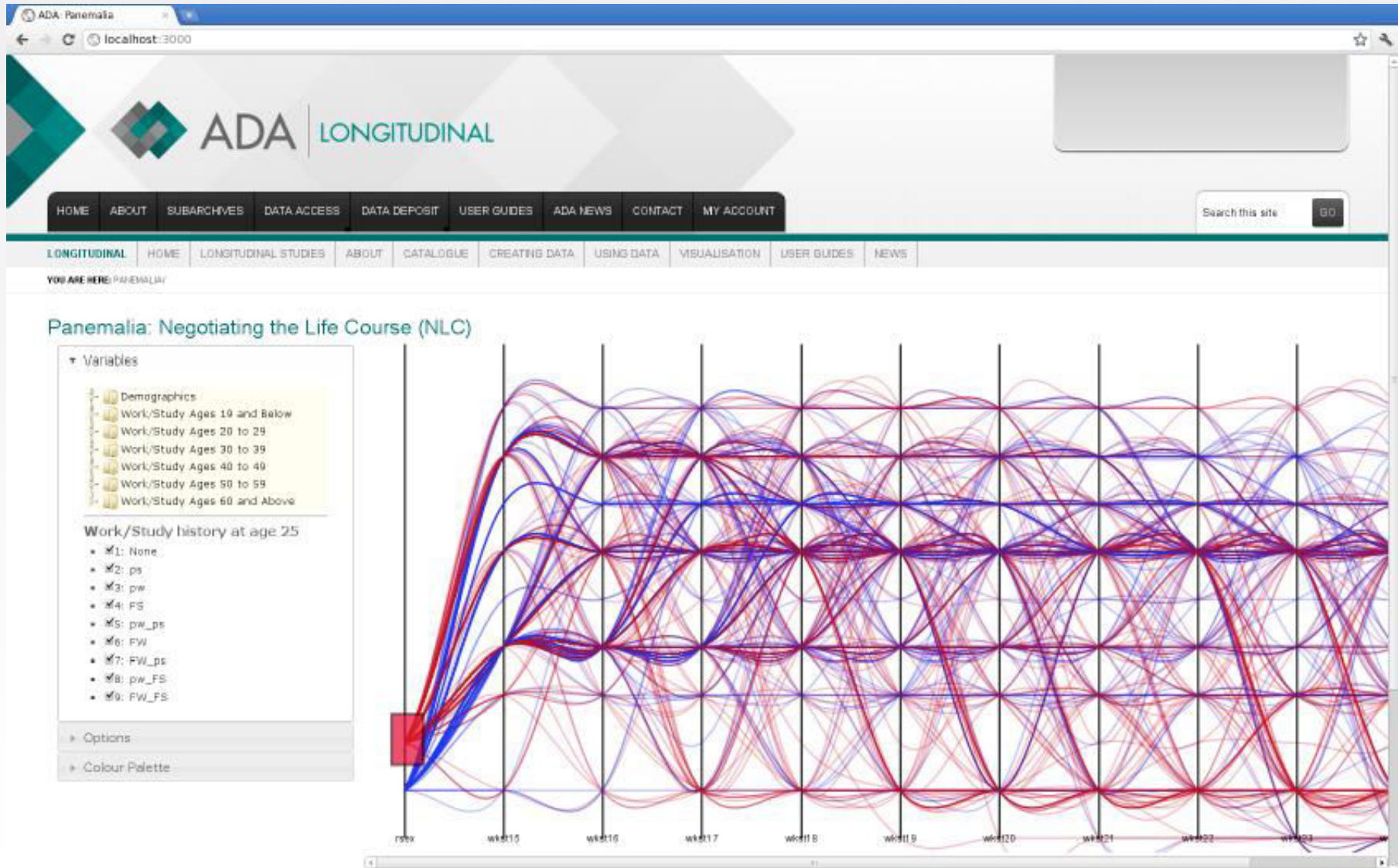


PDF

SHP

+

Longitudinal visualisation

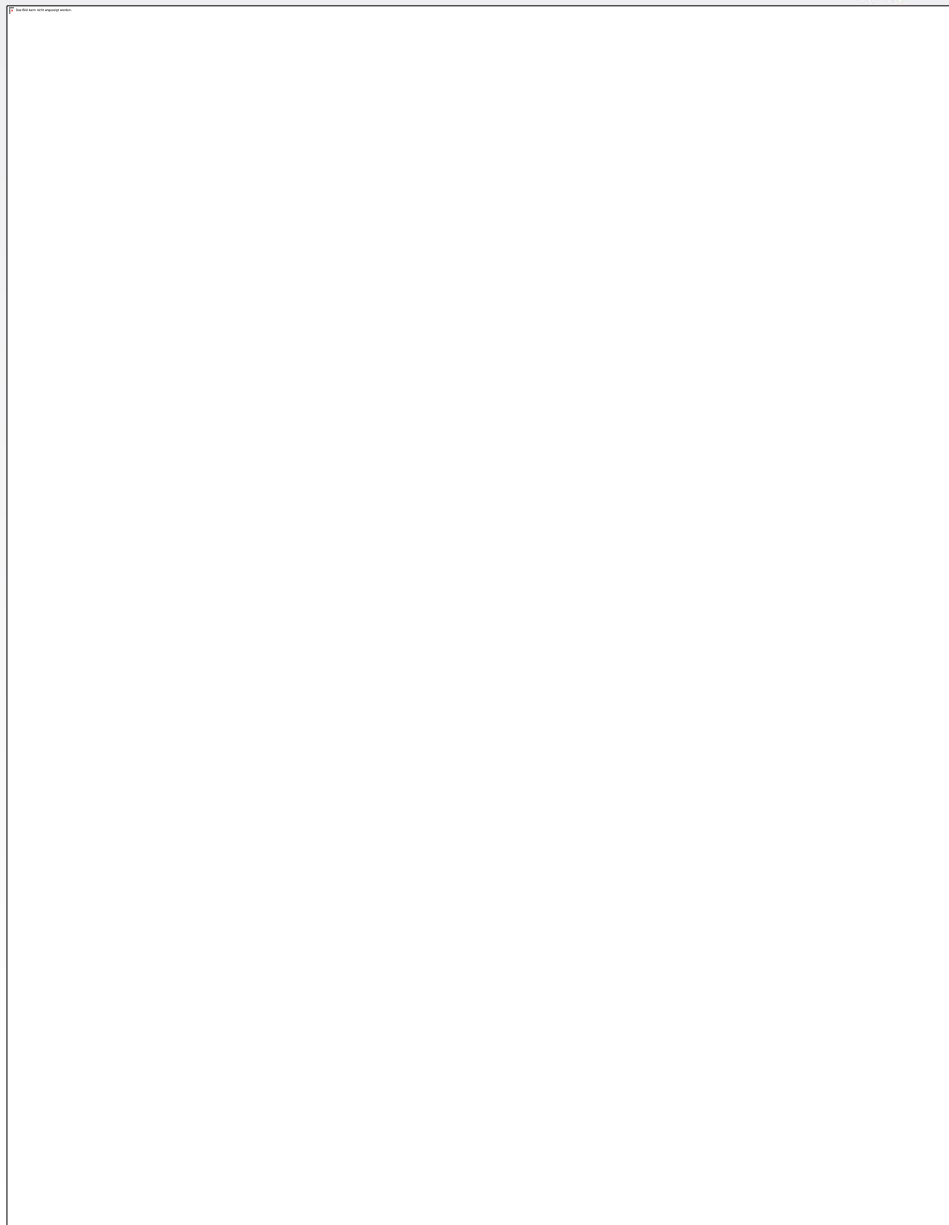




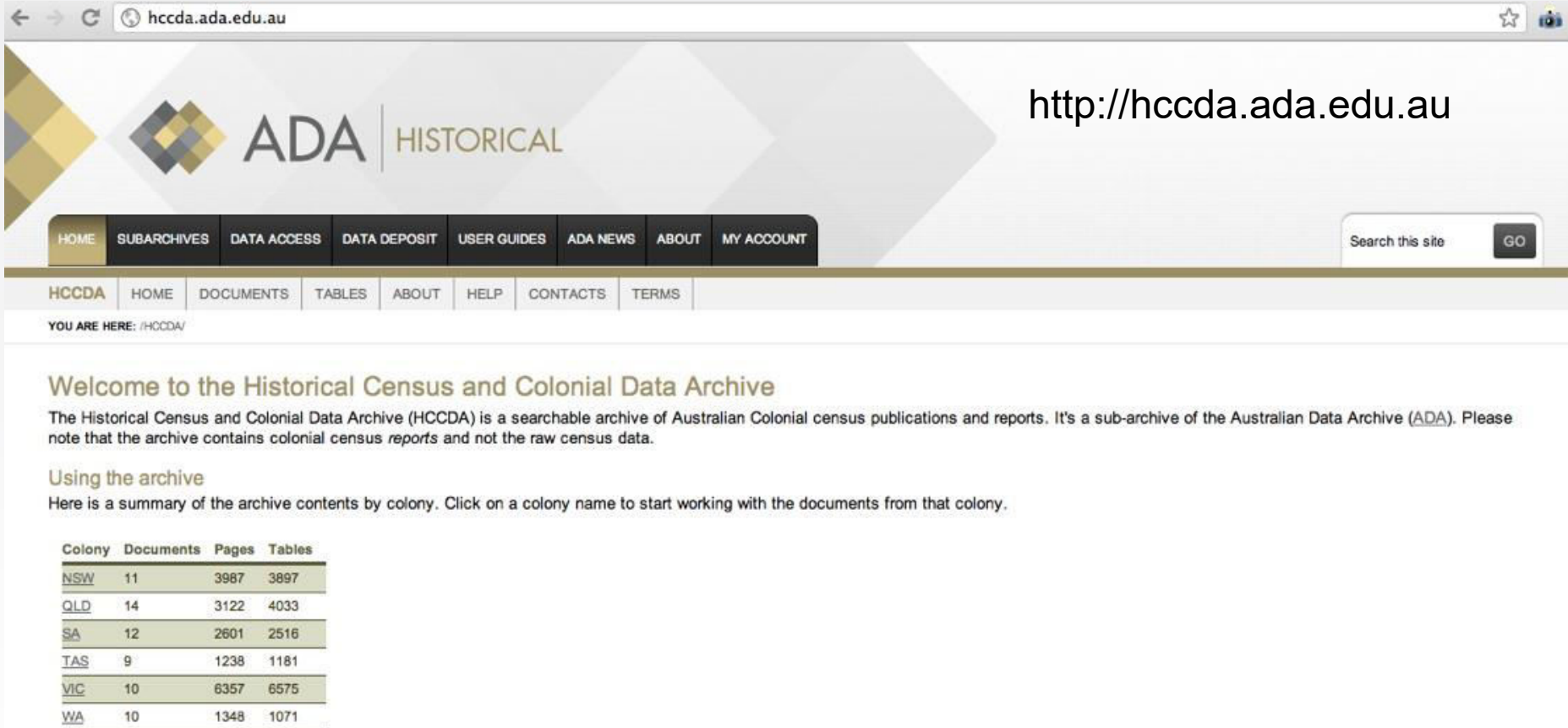
Data deposit: ADAPT



ADA AUSTRALIAN
DATA ARCHIVE



Historical Census data



The screenshot shows the HCCDA website interface. At the top, the URL <http://hccda.ada.edu.au> is displayed. The main header features the ADA HISTORICAL logo. Below this is a navigation bar with links: HOME, SUBARCHIVES, DATA ACCESS, DATA DEPOSIT, USER GUIDES, ADA NEWS, ABOUT, and MY ACCOUNT. A search bar is located on the right. The breadcrumb trail indicates the current location: YOU ARE HERE: /HCCDA/. The main content area welcomes visitors to the Historical Census and Colonial Data Archive, explaining its purpose as a searchable archive of Australian Colonial census publications and reports. It also provides a summary of the archive contents by colony, with a table listing the number of documents, pages, and tables for each colony.

<http://hccda.ada.edu.au>

ADA HISTORICAL

HOME SUBARCHIVES DATA ACCESS DATA DEPOSIT USER GUIDES ADA NEWS ABOUT MY ACCOUNT

Search this site GO

HCCDA HOME DOCUMENTS TABLES ABOUT HELP CONTACTS TERMS

YOU ARE HERE: /HCCDA/

Welcome to the Historical Census and Colonial Data Archive

The Historical Census and Colonial Data Archive (HCCDA) is a searchable archive of Australian Colonial census publications and reports. It's a sub-archive of the Australian Data Archive (ADA). Please note that the archive contains colonial census *reports* and not the raw census data.

Using the archive

Here is a summary of the archive contents by colony. Click on a colony name to start working with the documents from that colony.

Colony	Documents	Pages	Tables
NSW	11	3987	3897
QLD	14	3122	4033
SA	12	2601	2516
TAS	9	1238	1181
VIC	10	6357	6575
WA	10	1348	1071

A Note on Image and Markup Quality

Some of the original microfiche films that the archive has digitized are of poor quality, or mistakes have crept in to the fiche scanning process. We also expect that mistakes have also crept in to the process of creating XML markup from the page images. If you spot a document page image or markup that you believe has errors or is not of a high enough quality to use, then please let us know. Every document page has a comment form where you can leave comments or corrections or other notes, or you can contact us directly at the email addresses on the [contacts page](#).



Current experiences and future directions

Where are we now?

- New archive interface: <http://www.ada.edu.au>
- New thematic collections (indigenous, crime and justice, historical census, international)
- New methodological collections (longitudinal, qualitative)
- New analytical tools (particularly in visualisation)

Current experiences

Ingest and archiving

- DDI provides core of all of our data deposit and archival processes
- Nesstar provides storage foundation

Access

- Access services involve various transformations for data discovery and access
- CMS consumes DDI metadata
- Longitudinal and GIS viz systems require further processing:
 - ADA's use of geographic attributes are inconsistent over time
 - Longitudinal data management not suited to DDI2/DDI-C

Where to from here?

- Audio-visual (LIEF 2011-12)
- NeCTAR program: Data integration
 - Secure data access (administrative data, data linkage)
 - Qualitative data documentation and analysis
 - Historical/time series spatial analysis
 - Geospatial and temporal data integration
 - Integration across content types – eg.
 - Election results, poll results, candidate surveys
 - Census, survey and administrative data on a topic (eg. crime)

Questions or comments?

For further information

Web: <http://www.ada.edu.au>

Email: ada@anu.edu.au